My Chemical Romance Top the Charts, 20 Years On

From: Rolling Stone Music Mined: 2026-11-02 3 min read

Twenty years after it first came out, My Chemical Romance's album "The Black Parade" is Number One again. The new 20th anniversary version topped the Billboard 200 chart. It is the band's first Number One album in almost 25 years.

The new version sold 78,000 **equivalent album units** across more than 20 formats and versions, Billboard reports. The first album came out in 2006. It was the band's third album, a **rock opera** in the style of Queen, with the Top Ten hit "Welcome to the Black Parade." It first reached Number Two.

The band put out the 20th anniversary version on October 23. Sales of **physical copies** pushed it to the top. On Friday, the band also got its first Number One on the United Kingdom's album chart.

The old album beat a new album by Olivia Rodrigo. **Midweek** guesses said My Chemical Romance would win by a thousand sales. Rodrigo cheered them on and posted a clip from their show at Citi Field in New York, which she went to earlier this year.

The band is now on its Long Live the Black Parade tour, which started in 2025. Last year, they played two **sold-out** nights at Wembley Stadium in London.

Word Treasure

equivalent album units -- A chart count that adds album sales and song streams together.

rock opera -- An album that tells one story through its songs, like an opera.

physical copies -- Real albums you can hold, not just songs online.

sold-out -- All tickets sold, with no seats left.

Midweek -- In the middle of the week, before the final results.

Background you need

Album charts rank the most popular albums each week.

Bands sometimes release a special version of an old album for an anniversary.

Fans can help an old album climb the charts again by buying it.

Break it down

WHO: My Chemical Romance, a rock band
WHAT: Their album The Black Parade reached Number One again
WHERE: On the Billboard 200 chart and the United Kingdom's album chart
WHY: Fans bought the 20th anniversary version

Why it matters

Music you love can stay popular for years, and old songs can become new favorites.

Test what you remember

1. What album topped the Billboard 200?

- (A) The Black Parade
- (B) Welcome to the Black Parade
- (C) A new album by Olivia Rodrigo
- (D) Long Live the Black Parade

2. How much did the new version sell?

- (A) 1,000 sales
- (B) 78,000 equivalent album units
- (C) 20 formats
- (D) 25 years

3. When did the first album come out?

- (A) 2006
- (B) 2025
- (C) October 23
- (D) Friday

4. Who did the old album beat?

- (A) Queen
- (B) Billboard
- (C) Wembley Stadium
- (D) Olivia Rodrigo

5. What did Rodrigo do after the midweek guesses?

- (A) Played at Wembley Stadium
- (B) Cheered them on and posted a clip
- (C) Won by a thousand sales
- (D) Started the Long Live the Black Parade tour

6. Where did the band play two sold-out nights last year?

- (A) The United Kingdom's album chart
- (B) The Billboard 200
- (C) Wembley Stadium in London
- (D) Citi Field in New York

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):